



THE OXFORD UNIVERSITY REFORM SOCIETY

LAWS OF PUB GOLF

Michaelmas 2026 · First Edition

PREAMBLE

Golf was developed in Scotland, its name coming from ‘*gouf*’ to strike, and from the Dutch ‘*kolf*’ meaning to club.

In OURS, to begin Michaelmas, we will not be clubbing.

NOW THEREFORE the following Laws are adopted and shall bind all Players, Caddies and Spectators for the duration of the Round.

ARTICLE I — DEFINITIONS

1.1 In these Laws, unless the context otherwise requires:

"**the Society**" means the Oxford University Reform Society.

"**the Committee**" means the officers of the Society, whose interpretation of these Laws is final save where these Laws provide that the Caddy's is more final.

"**the Governor**" means the Governor of the Society or their nominee, who opens and closes the Round.

"**the Round**" means the whole of the evening's play, from the opening of the First Hole to the closing of the Last.

"**the Nineteenth**" means such resort as the party may keep after the Round is closed. No score is kept at the Nineteenth, and these Laws do not extend to it save for Article VIII, which does.

"**a Hole**" means a public house designated by the Committee at which a Drink is purchased and played. The identity of the Holes is not published in advance.

"**the Interval**" means a stop for food at which no Hole is played and no score is kept.

"**a Class**" means one of the three classes of Hole prescribed by Article IV.

"**the Drink**" means the beverage played by a Player at a Hole, alcoholic or otherwise.

"**a Vessel**" means a measure listed in Schedule C.



"a Sip" means one continuous act of drinking, beginning when the Vessel touches the lip and ending when it leaves it. A pause for breath ends a Sip. A pause for conversation ends a Sip, an argument, and usually the Player's chances.

"Par" means the number of Sips in which the Vessel elected ought properly to be completed, as prescribed by Schedule C.

"the Maximum" means Par plus five.

"the Caddy" means the officer appointed under Article VII.

"a Spectator" means any person accompanying the Round who is neither a Player nor a Caddy.

1.2 The singular includes the plural. References to a Schedule are to a Schedule to these Laws.

ARTICLE II - Attire

2.1 The Society shall run three Teams, in rouge, azure and pink.

2.2 Colours shall be allotted by the Committee under Rule 3.3 and notified to every Player not less than 1 day before the Round.

2.3 The uniform of the Round is a white shirt and, at the throat, a tie or neckerchief in the Player's colour. This is the minimum required. See Figure A.

2.4 Further articles in the Team colour are encouraged without limit: caps, socks, braces, blazers, pocket squares, trousers.

2.5 Caddies shall be turned out in black and white.

2.6 Colours shall be visible throughout the Round. Concealment, whether by coat, scarf or contrivance, is treated as failure to wear them and is penalised under Schedule A.

ARTICLE III - TEAMS

3.1 Players shall compete in Teams of not fewer than three. No maximum is prescribed.

3.2 Teams shall be of equal size. Where the number of Players does not divide evenly, no Team shall exceed any other by more than one Player.

3.3 The Committee shall allot Players to Teams. A Player may state a preference on the sign-up form; the Committee shall have regard to it and is bound by nothing.



3.4 Where under Rule 3.2 a Team has one Player fewer than another, there shall be added to that Team's aggregate, at the close of the Round, the mean score of its own Players. Arithmetic is the Caddies' burden, not the Players'.

3.5 Each Team shall carry a Scorecard, which may be physical or digital.

ARTICLE IV — THE COURSE AND THE CLASSES OF HOLE

4.1 The Course shall be walked. Taxis, buses and bicycles are out of bounds and are penalised under Schedule A.

4.2 The Committee shall designate the Holes.

4.3 Every Hole is of one of three Classes, declared by the Caddy on opening:

(a) a **Beer Hole**, at which a Player may elect a pint or a half pint;

(b) a **Wine Hole**, at which a Player may elect a small, medium or large glass;

(c) an **Other Hole**, at which the Drink is specified by the Committee.

4.4 A Player shall elect their Vessel to the Caddy before purchase. A Vessel not elected before purchase is scored at the Maximum.

4.5 A Player who plays a Vessel not permitted at the Class of that Hole is penalised under Schedule A and the Hole is scored at the Maximum.

4.6 Each Player shall play one Drink at each Hole. A second Drink is not scored, confers no advantage, and is the Player's own affair.

4.7 At an Other Hole the Committee may specify a shared Vessel, including but not limited to steins, pitchers, jugs and flagons. Where it does:

(a) the Par of that Vessel is the Par of the Team for that Hole;

(b) the Sips of every Player count toward it;

ARTICLE V — PLAY

5.1 The Round is opened and closed by the Committee

5.2 Play at a Hole begins when the Caddy declares the Hole open and announces its Class.



5.3 A Hole shall be completed within thirty minutes of opening. A Team failing to do so incurs the Slow Play penalty under Schedule A.

5.4 The Caddy shall initial the Scorecard at the conclusion of every Hole. An unsigned Hole is void and is scored at the Maximum for every Player in the Team.

5.5 Each Team may, once in the Round, declare a Mulligan: the worst Player score at that Hole is struck from the record and replaced by Par. A Mulligan must be declared before the Caddy signs, and does not require that any further Drink be taken.

5.6 No Player shall publish a photograph or recording of another Player taken during the Round, without that Player's consent.

5.7 Where a Hole cannot be played, the Caddy shall declare the Hole void. A void Hole is scored at Par for every Team and the Round proceeds.

ARTICLE VI — SCORING

6.1 A Player's score at a Hole is the number of Sips taken, expressed relative to the Par of the Vessel elected.

6.2 Accordingly, at a Vessel of Par 3: completion in three Sips scores level (0); in two, one under (-1); in four, one over (+1).

6.3 No Player shall score more than the Maximum at a Hole before penalties.

6.4 A Drink completed in a single Sip is a Hole in One and scores -3. A Hole in One may be claimed only upon a Vessel of Par 3 or more; upon a Vessel of Par 1 or 2, completion in a single Sip scores as Rule 6.1 provides and no more.

6.5 A Team's score at a Hole is the sum of its Players' scores at that Hole, together with any penalty or reward falling on the Team.

6.6 Penalties and rewards under Schedules A and B are applied to the score for the Hole at which they were incurred.

6.7 The Team with the lowest aggregate at the close of the Round is the winner. In the event of a tie, the Caddies shall confer, and the winning team shall be selected.

6.8 The result is announced by the Committee. The winning Team shall receive a prize provided by the Committee.

6.9 *Note for Players, forming no part of these Laws.* The small Vessels are safe and cannot win. A half pint or a small glass is Par 1: it cannot be beaten, only matched or missed. A pint,



a large glass or a shared Vessel carries the only real upside on the card. The Laws reward ambition, and they reward it at the Player's own expense.

ARTICLE VII — THE CADDY

7.1 Each Team shall be attended by a Caddy, appointed by the Committee.

7.2 The Caddy is an independent referee. The Caddy is not required to drink alcohol at any point during the Round and does not compete.

7.3 The Caddy's decision is final. It is final when it is right, and it is final when it is wrong.

7.4 Each Team's Caddy keeps that Team's score. The Caddy's count is the only count. No Player's own reckoning shall be entertained, and no Team shall be required to score another.

7.5 The Caddy shall: (a) open and close each Hole and declare its Class; (b) record each Player's election under Rule 4.4; (c) sign the Scorecard; (d) rule on all Sips, spillages and disputes; (e) count the Team at the door of every Hole, on entry and on departure.

7.6 The Caddy may at any time retire a Player from the Hole. A Player so retired keeps the score accrued to that point, which shall stand for the remainder of the Hole without further penalty. That Player may not rejoin the Hole from which they were retired, but may play subsequent Holes. No Player shall be prevailed upon to continue.

7.7 In the interest of safety, the Caddy shall remind players not to leave their drinks unattended and may at any time request to inspect each Player for illicit items.

7.8 Any attempt to influence a Caddy's impartiality, by inducement, pressure or flattery, is penalised under Schedule A.

ARTICLE VIII — CONDUCT

8.1 This Article binds Players, Caddies and Spectators during the Round.

8.2 Players shall at all times comply with the reasonable instructions of the staff of any public house on the Course.

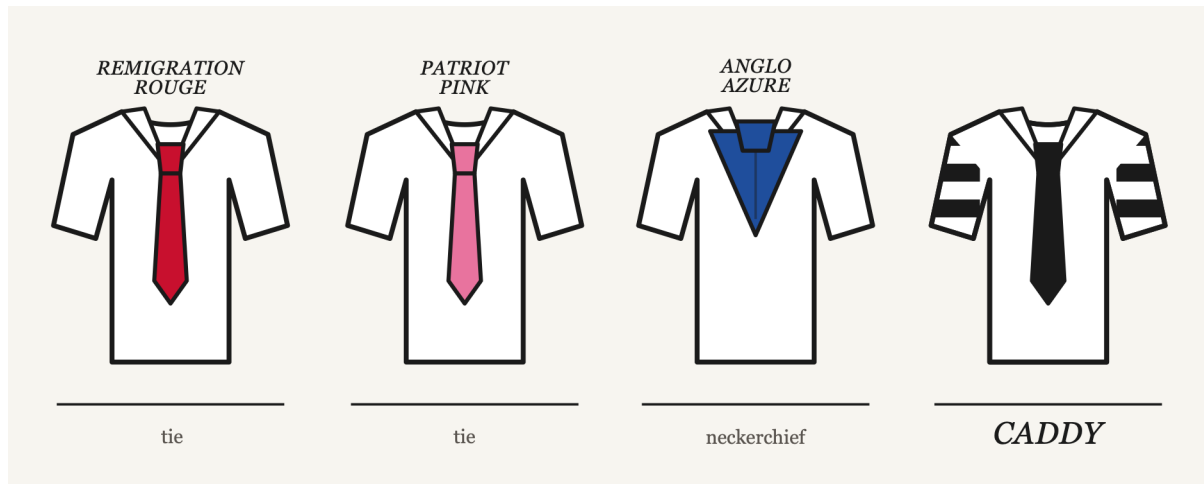
8.3 No Team shall enter a Hole in such number as to occupy it unreasonably.

8.4 The Committee shall ensure water is available at every Hole. Players are expected to eat before play begins.

8.6 Players are expected to eat before play begins, and again at the Interval.

8.7 The Society's ordinary standards of conduct apply throughout, and apply with greater force rather than less for the fact that alcohol is involved. Any Player may be removed from the Round by a Caddy or a member of the Committee for bringing the Society into disrepute.

FIGURE A - ATTIRE EXAMPLES



SCHEDULE A - PENALTIES

Offence	Penalty
Failure to wear Team colours	+1
Concealing or removing Team colours	+1
Slow play (Hole not completed within thirty minutes)	+2
Spillage	+2, and see A.2 below
Falling down, or off one's seat (<i>out of bounds</i>)	+3
Losing a Player (<i>lost ball</i>)	+3,
Yelling at a Caddy	+5
Offering a Caddy an inducement	+5
Being removed from a public house	+5
Cheating	+10
Engaging in a drunken fracas	+10
Rudeness to bar staff	+10, and the offender buys the Caddy dinner

A.1 A penalty expressed without qualification falls on the Player. A penalty expressed as falling on the Team falls on the Team.



A.2 A Player causing a spillage shall pay for the replacement. The Player whose Drink was spilt shall be allowed such additional time as the Caddy considers just.

SCHEDULE B - REWARDS

Achievement	Reward
Every member of a Team completing a Hole under Par	-2 to the Team

SCHEDULE C — TABLE OF PARS

C.1 Beer Holes

Vessel	Par
Half pint	1
Pint	3

C.2 Wine Holes

Vessel	Par
Small glass – 125ml	1
Medium glass – 175ml	2
Large glass – 250ml	3

C.3 Other Holes — individual Vessels

Vessel	Measure	Par
Spirit and mixer, single	25 ml	2
Spirit and mixer, double	50 ml	3

C.4 Other Holes — shared Vessels (Rule 4.7)

Vessel	Measure	Team Par
Stein	1 litre	5
Pitcher	4 pints	10